MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 18

"Back in the Day"

Episode 2x18. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x18 (the Sloan arrival and the flashback episode). Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Monday, February 13, 2006 (the morning after the Blizzard of 2006), 6:11 AM through 11:58 PM, with flashbacks to March 10-11, 1990

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 40 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x17

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Monday, February 13, 2006 (flashback ages are given in the scene action)). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Monday, February 13, 2006 (flashback ages are given in the scene action))

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery (also seen at 31, in 1990)	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Malcolm Sloan (on-screen debut)	Chief of Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery (first day)	Feb 14, 1968	37
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	46
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	27
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern (27 since February 10)	Feb 10, 1979	27
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern	Jun 11, 1978	27
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Dr. Nnamdi Okoye (new)	Surgical Resident (PGY-4), covering Elxa's leave	Oct 1, 1974	31
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Gunnery Sgt. Ezekiel Holcomb, USMC (Ret.) (new)	Patient: severe accidental hypothermia, cardiac arrest	Jul 4, 1951	54
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	50
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Zaria Holmes (new)	Patient, 7: dog bite, facial avulsion, depressed skull fracture	Sep 3, 1998	7
Trina Holmes (new)	Zaria's mother	Dec 15, 1976	29
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	59
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband (post-craniectomy)	Apr 3, 1975	30
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (maternity leave)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Joan Mercer (flashback)	Marc's grandmother, at 54 in 1990	Apr 17, 1935	70
Dr. Victor Donohue (flashback)	Marc's grandfather, at 56 in 1990	May 30, 1933	72
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: Status 1A, day 94; LVAD consented	Aug 8, 1971	34
Glenda Duvall	Dash's mother	Dec 12, 1947	58
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Augustin Toussaint (V.O.)	Camille's father	Feb 9, 1941	65
Dr. Harold Bynum	Consult-Liaison Psychiatrist	Oct 19, 1942	63
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Russell Harmon 'Tuck' Jeffries Jr.	Elxa's son (8 days old)	Feb 5, 2006	0
Mercy	The House's pit bull puppy	Sep 30, 2005	0

Also appearing (flashback): Young Marc, age 11, in March 1990. Also appearing: a hospital volunteer, a perfusionist, paramedics, the meeting chairpersons and members at Saint Paul's (1990) and St. Mary's (2006), and a plow driver. Mentioned: Imani and Angela Burrell, Sgt. Isaac Burrell (funeral, Friday, February 10, Greater Allen Cathedral), Corinne Smilley, Dr. Delphine Ware, Alphonse, Mr. Duvall Sr. (d. June 9, 1990) and Celia Montague.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. THE DONOHUE-BULLOCK APARTMENT - BROOKLINE, MASSACHUSETTS - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FLASHBACK: SATURDAY, MARCH 10, 1990 - 11:41 PM

A narrow 1980s kitchen with avocado-green appliances and a calendar from Brigham and Women's Hospital on the fridge. A pot on the stove has boiled dry. Black smoke curls up from it. At the table, slumped forward on her folded arms beside an empty bottle of Chablis, NATASHA DONOHUE (31) is asleep, or unconscious. Her white coat hangs on the back of the chair.

The smoke alarm screams. A small boy in Batman pajamas runs into the kitchen: YOUNG MARC (11). He sees the flames licking up from the pot. He sees his mother at the table. He doesn't scream.

He drags a chair to the cabinet under the sink, climbs onto it, pulls out a red fire extinguisher nearly as big as he is, pulls the pin the way his grandfather taught him, and sprays the stove until the fire is gone. White powder everywhere. The alarm keeps screaming.

MARC (V.O.)
Everybody has a day they don't talk about.

Young Marc climbs down. He turns off the burner. He opens the window. He waves a dish towel at the smoke alarm until it stops. Then he goes to the table and shakes his mother's shoulder.

YOUNG MARC
(quietly, as if he's done this before)
Mama. (beat) Mama, wake up. (beat) You have to go to bed.

Natasha lifts her head. She sees the white powder. The black pot. Her son in his pajamas with the extinguisher at his feet. Her face changes. Something in it breaks.

NATASHA
(slurring, then not)
Marc. (beat) Oh, God. (beat) Marc.

MARC (V.O.)
A day so big that every day after it is shaped around the hole it left.

2 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - MAIN LOBBY - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 7:02 AM

Present day. The lobby, muddy with tracked-in slush. Outside the windows, Jackson Avenue is buried under the biggest snowfall in the city's recorded history: two feet of white piled into man-high drifts along the curbs, and plows grinding past. A man comes through the revolving door stamping snow off expensive boots: tall, broad-shouldered, impossibly handsome, salt-and-pepper at the temples, in a cashmere overcoat with a leather briefcase. DR. MALCOLM SLOAN (37).

He looks around the lobby. He looks up at the ceiling, at the old terrazzo floor, at the security desk. Big Ray (46) looks back at him.

MALCOLM
(warm Boston accent, charming)
Good morning. (beat) Malcolm Sloan. (beat) First day. (beat) Plastics. (beat) Seventh floor?

BIG RAY
(beat, not charmed at all)
Elevators are to your left, Dr. Sloan.

MALCOLM
(beat)
Is there another way up? (beat) The stairs? (beat) The east stairs?

Big Ray studies him for a long beat. Then he points.

BIG RAY
(beat)
East stairs are past the gift shop. (beat) Seven flights.

MALCOLM
(beat, already walking)
Thank you. (beat) I could use the exercise.

MARC (V.O.)
And then one morning, it walks back into your life through the front door.

He disappears toward the east stairs. Big Ray picks up his phone.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 6:11 AM

Earlier that morning. The kitchen window is half blocked by snow piled against the glass. The TV on the counter shows NY1: "RECORD! 26.9 INCHES IN CENTRAL PARK -- BIGGEST SNOWSTORM SINCE 1869." Raven (26) eats cereal. Harmony (26) makes coffee. Amond (27 since Friday, the tenth) reads. Marc (27), the cut over his eyebrow healed to a pink line, stands at the counter. Mercy pushes her nose against the back door, desperate to go out into the snow.

HARMONY
(beat)
You went to the funeral Friday.

MARC
(beat)
Greater Allen Cathedral. (beat) In Jamaica. (beat) Two thousand cops. (beat) Bagpipes.

RAVEN
(beat, gently)
And Imani?

Marc doesn't answer for a second.

MARC
(beat)
I bought it. (beat) The Sidekick. (beat) Pink. (beat) T-Mobile store on Steinway. (beat) I gave it to her mother at the repast. (beat) I put a card in it that said "From your daddy. He said yes."

A silence. Harmony sets down the coffee pot.

AMOND
(beat, not looking up from his journal)
How's your hearing?

MARC
(beat)
Fine.

AMOND
(beat)
How's your sleep?

MARC
(beat)
Fine.

Outside, a city snowplow roars past on 49th Avenue, blade scraping the asphalt, and a ridge of snow slams against the stoop with a heavy boom. Marc flinches so hard his coffee spills across the counter. Everyone in the kitchen sees it. He grabs a dish towel and wipes it up, not looking at anyone.

MARC
(beat, too casually)
Fine.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 6:44 AM

The interns change, damp from the snow. Esther (26) sits on the bench lacing her shoes with her jaw tight. Arianna (26) and Kennerly (27) at their lockers. Marc comes in. The door bangs open behind him. Kendra Wallace (25), breathless.

KENDRA
(beat)
He's here.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Who?

KENDRA
(beat)
The new Plastics chief. (beat) From Boston. (beat) He came in the front door at seven o'clock and asked Big Ray for the east stairs. (beat) Ray says he looks like a cologne ad.

Everyone looks at Esther. Esther keeps lacing her shoe. She ties a perfect double knot. Then she stands up.

ESTHER
(beat, flat)
He's early. (beat) He was supposed to start at nine. (beat) He's always early. (beat) He was early for my First Communion. (beat) He sat in the front pew in a tie.

MARC
(quietly)
Esther.

ESTHER
(beat)
I'm fine, Marc. (beat) I'm going to rounds. (beat) And if I see him, I'm going to say "Good morning, Dr. Sloan," because I'm a professional. (beat) And then I'm going to go to the OR.

She leaves. Kennerly watches the door swing shut.

KENNERLY
(beat, dry)
Twenty bucks says she doesn't say "good morning."

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - NURSES' STATION - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 6:58 AM

A new resident runs the board in Elxa's place: DR. NNAMDI OKOYE (31), a fourth-year, tall and calm, recovered from his flu. The interns gather. Behind him, on the wall, someone has taped up a newspaper photo of Isaac Burrell in his dress uniform, and a sign beneath it in marker: "SGT. ISAAC BURRELL. 1961-2006. HE WALKED IT OUT."

OKOYE
(beat)
Good morning. (beat) Dr. Bullock is on maternity leave until April. (beat) I'm Dr. Okoye. (beat) Dr. Bullock left me eleven pages of instructions about you people. (beat) Page one says, "Don't let Kennerly near the potassium." (beat) Page four says, "Divine can deliver anything." (beat) Page eleven just says, "Watch Bullock."

Marc looks up.

OKOYE
(reading off)
City's under two feet of snow. (beat) Frostbite, hypothermia, heart attacks from shoveling, slip-and-falls. (beat) Kennerly, Cummings: ER. (beat) Ellison: CVICU. (beat) Baker: Cardio. (beat) Divine: Ortho. (beat) Smilley: Neuro, Dr. Graves. (beat) Bullock: Dr. Lowery.

MARC
(beat)
I'm fine to go to the ER.

OKOYE
(beat, not looking up)
Page eleven, Dr. Bullock. (beat) You're with Lowery.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 2 - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 7:21 AM

Paramedics rush in a gurney. On it, a big, bearded man in his fifties, gray and waxy, frost in his beard, unresponsive. Layers of filthy clothes. A wool Marine Corps watch cap. Kennerly, Arianna and Gloria meet them.

PARAMEDIC
(fast)
Found in a snowbank under the Pulaski Bridge ramp. (beat) Homeless. (beat) Sanitation found him plowing. (beat) Pulseless on our arrival. (beat) CPR fourteen minutes. (beat) Rhythm's V-fib, fine. (beat) We shocked twice. (beat) Nothing.

KENNERLY
(taking over compressions, fast)
Core temp?

GLORIA
(reading the esophageal probe)
Twenty-four point one. (beat) Celsius.

ARIANNA
(beat)
He's been dead fourteen minutes, Kennerly.

KENNERLY
(pumping, steady)
He's not dead until he's warm and dead. (beat) Warmed saline, forty-two degrees, wide open. (beat) Bladder lavage. (beat) Chest tubes, both sides, warm irrigation. (beat) And page the perfusionist. (beat) If we can't warm him, we put him on bypass.

Arianna looks at him. Then she grabs a chest tube tray.

GLORIA
(quietly, to Kennerly)
Where'd you learn that?

KENNERLY
(pumping)
Thanksgiving. (beat) Mrs. Divine's plate. (beat) I read the whole hypothermia chapter in the break room while I ate it.

Gloria looks at the Marine Corps watch cap on the floor. She picks it up and sets it carefully on the counter.

GLORIA
(beat)
He's a Marine. (beat) Sergeant Burrell was a Marine.

KENNERLY
(beat, not stopping)
Then he doesn't die on my table this week.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PLASTIC SURGERY SUITE - CORRIDOR - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 7:38 AM

The seventh floor, quiet. Malcolm, a little winded from seven flights, his coat over his arm, stands in front of his own nameplate: "MALCOLM SLOAN, M.D., F.A.C.S. -- CHIEF, DIVISION OF PLASTIC AND RECONSTRUCTIVE SURGERY." He touches it with one finger. The elevator at the end of the hall dings. The doors open. Esther steps out with a chart.

They see each other. Fifteen feet of corridor between them. Neither moves.

MALCOLM
(beat, very quietly)
Est.

Esther walks down the corridor toward him. Steady. Her face perfectly calm. She stops in front of him.

ESTHER
(beat)
Good morning, Dr. Sloan.

MALCOLM
(beat, barely)
Good morning, Dr. Smilley.

Esther looks at him for one more second. Then she draws back her right arm and punches him in the face. A solid, perfect right cross from a hardware store owner's daughter from Mattapan who grew up with four sisters. Malcolm staggers back against his own office door. Blood springs from his nose.

He doesn't raise his hands. He doesn't step back. He stands there and lets it bleed.

MALCOLM
(beat, thickly)
I deserved that.

ESTHER
(beat, shaking her hand)
You deserved that in February. (beat) That's for the stairs.

MALCOLM
(beat)
The stairs?

ESTHER
(beat)
You took the east stairs. (beat) Seven flights. (beat) So I wouldn't have to see you. (beat) I told Clayton I want you to use the elevator, Malcolm. (beat) I don't want you hiding from me in my own building.

At the end of the corridor, a nurse and two residents have frozen in the doorway of the Plastics clinic, staring. Malcolm takes a handkerchief from his breast pocket and presses it to his nose.

MALCOLM
(beat, muffled)
Then I'll take the elevator.

ESTHER
(beat, turning to go)
Good. (beat) Welcome to Queens Grace. (beat) Happy birthday tomorrow.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - MORNING
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 7:52 AM

Natasha (47) at her desk, the window behind her white with snow. She hasn't touched her tea. Robert (49) stands at the window with his back to her. It's the eighth day since

he promised.

NATASHA
(beat)
You said this week. (beat) It's been eight days.

ROBERT
(beat, not turning)
I know.

NATASHA
(beat)
The funeral was Friday. (beat) The blizzard was Saturday and Sunday. (beat) Every day there's been a reason. (beat) Today there isn't one, Robert.

Robert turns around. He looks at his wife. He has stood in front of a thousand families and told them the worst news of their lives. He can't find the first word.

Bernie (55) knocks on the open door. She looks like she's about to explode with news.

BERNIE
(beat)
Dr. Donohue. (beat) I'm so sorry. (beat) Dr. Sloan has a broken nose.

NATASHA
(beat, staring)
He's been here forty-five minutes.

BERNIE
(beat)
Yes, ma'am. (beat) Dr. Smilley. (beat) In the Plastics corridor. (beat) Three witnesses. (beat) He says he walked into a door and he won't file anything.

Natasha closes her eyes. Robert, at the window, lets out a breath that might be a laugh or might be relief at the reprieve.

NATASHA
(beat, opening her eyes, to Robert)
Don't. (beat) Don't you dare look relieved. (beat) We're having this conversation today. (beat) After I deal with this.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PLASTIC SURGERY SUITE - MALCOLM'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 8:07 AM

A corner office, half unpacked. Boxes of journals. A framed photograph of five girls on a Mattapan stoop with a gangly teenage boy, propped on the windowsill. Malcolm stands in front of a mirror on the back of the door, two cotton swabs up his nose, studying the angle of the bridge. He grips it between his thumbs and, with a sharp crack, resets it himself. He grunts. His eyes water.

A knock. The door opens. Clayton (34) stands in the doorway. The first time they've been in a room together since a bedroom in Back Bay a year ago. Neither of them speaks.

MALCOLM
(finally, nasal, not turning from the mirror)
Clay.

CLAYTON
(beat)
You set it yourself.

MALCOLM
(beat)
I'm a plastic surgeon. (beat) If I let somebody else do it, they'd do it wrong.

Clayton comes in and closes the door. He stands with his back against it.

CLAYTON
(beat)
She hit you.

MALCOLM
(beat, almost smiling)
Right cross. (beat) Her father taught all five of them. (beat) In the back of the hardware store. (beat) I was there. (beat) I held the heavy bag.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
I'm not going to hit you, Malcolm.

MALCOLM
(beat, turning around at last)
I know. (beat) You never could. (beat) That was always the problem with us.

A long, terrible silence. Clayton looks at the photograph on the windowsill.

CLAYTON
(beat)
We have a rule. (beat) Esther and me. (beat) No more Octobers. (beat) It means nothing gets hidden. (beat) So I'm going to say this once, in this room, with the door closed. (beat) I'm her husband. (beat) I'm staying her husband. (beat) Whatever you came here to rebuild, it isn't us.

MALCOLM
(beat, quietly)
I didn't come for you, Clay. (beat) I came for her. (beat) For the Smilleys. (beat) For Ma Corinne's table. (beat) I came to be in the same building as the only family I ever had. (beat) Even if she never says another word to me except "Good morning, Dr. Sloan."

CLAYTON
(beat)
She said more than that.

MALCOLM
(beat, touching his nose)
She did.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - PEDIATRIC BAY - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 8:24 AM

A little girl in a pink snowsuit, ZARIA HOLMES (7), lies on the gurney, screaming, a blood-soaked towel pressed to the left side of her face and scalp. Her mother, TRINA HOLMES (29), a hospital billing clerk, is hysterical. Lowery and Marc at the bedside. A nurse holds the girl's hand.

TRINA
(sobbing)
The neighbor's dog. (beat) In the courtyard. (beat) In the snow. (beat) She was making a snow angel. (beat) It just came out of nowhere. (beat) A pit bull. (beat) It grabbed her face and wouldn't let go.

Marc goes very still at the words "pit bull." He thinks of Mercy, the one ear up, asleep on his chest. He pushes the thought away.

LOWERY
(gently lifting the towel)
Zaria. (beat) Honey, I'm going to look. (beat) You hold the nurse's hand.

Under the towel: a deep, ragged laceration from the left eyebrow across the temple into the scalp, a flap of skin and muscle torn loose, and in the scalp, bone visible. Lowery and Marc exchange a glance.

MARC
(beat, quiet, professional)
Facial avulsion, left temple and forehead. (beat) Scalp laceration with exposed bone. (beat) Possible depressed skull fracture. (beat) Her pupils are equal and reactive. (beat) She's talking.

LOWERY
(beat)
CT head and face. (beat) Ancef. (beat) Tetanus. (beat) Rabies protocol until animal control quarantines the dog. (beat) Page Neurosurgery. (beat) And Plastics.

MARC
(beat)
Plastics is Dr. Sloan.

LOWERY
(beat, dry)
Then I imagine his first case at Queens Grace is going to be very interesting.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 2 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 8:39 AM

The frozen man is now connected to a heart-lung bypass machine through tubes in his groin. Dark blood flows out, through the warming circuit and back in. Robert, gowned, has just finished cannulating. Amond monitors the pump with the perfusionist. Kennerly, exhausted from an hour of chest compressions, stands back. Gloria reads the temperature.

GLORIA
(beat)
Core temp twenty-seven point eight. (beat) Twenty-eight point five.

ROBERT
(watching the monitor)
One degree every five to ten minutes. (beat) At thirty, we shock again.

AMOND
(beat)
He's been in arrest for an hour and ten minutes, sir.

ROBERT
(beat)
Hypothermia protects the brain, Dr. Baker. (beat) The record for survival with good neurologic recovery is over six hours of CPR. (beat) Hold on.

They wait. The pump hums. Kennerly stares at the man's face under the frost-burned beard.

KENNERLY
(beat, quietly)
His cap said USMC. (beat) I found a VA card in his coat. (beat) Ezekiel Holcomb. (beat) Fifty-four. (beat) Gunnery sergeant. (beat) Beirut, 1983.

GLORIA
(beat)
Twenty-nine point nine. (beat)
Thirty.

ROBERT
(beat)
Paddles. (beat) Two hundred.

Kennerly takes the paddles from Gloria's hands before anyone else can. Robert looks at him and nods.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Clear.

Shock. The body jumps. The monitor shows a flat line, then a squiggle, then a beat. Then another. Narrow complexes. Sinus rhythm.

AMOND
(beat, barely)
We have a rhythm.

GLORIA
(quietly)
Lord. (beat) Lord, look at that.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 9:02 AM

Natasha at her desk. Malcolm sits across from her with a splint taped over his nose and two black eyes beginning to form. He looks like a movie star who's lost a fight.

NATASHA
(beat)
Dr. Sloan. (beat) You've been employed at this hospital for two hours. (beat) You have a broken nose.

MALCOLM
(beat)
I walked into a door, Dr. Donohue.

NATASHA
(beat)
The door is a surgical intern in my department. (beat) Her name is on three witness statements Bernie has typed up and placed on my desk. (beat) I've decided not to read them.

Malcolm looks at her.

NATASHA
(beat)
I know what happened in Boston, Dr. Sloan. (beat) Not from Dr. Smilley. (beat) Not from Dr. Hartwell. (beat) I'm the Chief of Surgery. (beat) It's my job to know what walks in the door with every man I hire.

MALCOLM
(beat, quietly)
Then you know why I'm here.

NATASHA
(beat)
I know you're the best plastic surgeon on the East Coast. (beat) That's why you're here. (beat) Everything else is your business. (beat) Until it becomes my business in an operating room. (beat) Then it's mine. (beat) Do we understand each other?

MALCOLM
(beat)
Completely.

NATASHA
(beat, standing)
Good. (beat) There's a seven-year-old girl in the ER whose face was torn off by a dog. (beat) Dr. Graves is taking her for a depressed skull fracture. (beat) His intern is Dr. Smilley. (beat) You'll do the face when he's done with the skull. (beat) You'll be in the same OR. (beat) For about five hours.

Malcolm closes his eyes for a second.

MALCOLM
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO STEP-DOWN - ROOM 3 - DAY

MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 9:24 AM

Russell sits up in bed, extubated now, the right side of his head shaved and soft where the bone flap is missing, a padded protective helmet on the tray table beside him. His left hand is still weak. His voice is hoarse. Elxa sits in the chair, eight days postpartum, in jeans and a sweater for the first time in months, Tuck asleep in a carrier at her feet.

RUSSELL
(slowly, carefully)
Did we really... (beat) name him after Harmony?

ELXA
(beat)
Harmon. (beat) Middle name. (beat) You were unconscious. (beat) I made an executive decision.

RUSSELL
(beat, a slow smile)
Good decision. (beat) Tuck.

ELXA
(beat)
Tuck.

He looks at the baby in the carrier for a long time.

RUSSELL
(beat)
I don't remember. (beat) The cab. (beat) The light. (beat) Nothing after "carefully." (beat) You said "carefully," and then I woke up and you were holding a baby.

ELXA
(beat, taking his good hand)
You were careful, Russell. (beat) You stopped at a red light. (beat) The cab didn't.

RUSSELL
(beat)
Graves says six weeks. (beat) Then they put my skull back. (beat) I have to wear that helmet whenever I'm out of bed. (beat) I'm a chemistry teacher in a helmet.

ELXA
(beat, deadpan)
The step team will love it.

Russell laughs, winces, and laughs again. Tuck stirs in the carrier and starts to fuss. Elxa picks him up and lays him on Russell's chest, under his good arm. The baby settles immediately.

RUSSELL
(beat, whispering)
Hey, little man. (beat) I'm here. (beat) I'm here now.

14 INT. THE DONOHUE-BULLOCK APARTMENT - BROOKLINE - KITCHEN - MORNING
FLASHBACK: SUNDAY, MARCH 11, 1990 - 8:15 AM

The morning after. The kitchen still smells of smoke. White extinguisher powder in the corners. Natasha, thirty-one, sits at the table in a robe, her hands wrapped around a mug of coffee, gray-faced, shaking. Across from her, upright as a church pew in a tweed suit and pearls, sits DR. JOAN MERCER (54), her mother. VICTOR DONOHUE (56) stands at the counter. In the doorway, in his Batman pajamas, Young Marc watches, unseen.

JOAN
(calm, absolutely firm)
There's a meeting at Saint Paul's in Brookline at ten o'clock. (beat) Basement. (beat) I've already called. (beat) You're going.

NATASHA
(barely)
Mama.

JOAN
(beat)
Your son put out a fire on your stove last night with a fire extinguisher, Natasha. (beat) He's eleven. (beat) Robert is in Baltimore and doesn't know. (beat) Your father found you on the kitchen floor at six this morning. (beat) You are going.

NATASHA
(beat, crying)
I'm a doctor. (beat) I'm an obstetrician at Brigham and Women's. (beat) I can't walk into a church basement and say "I'm an alcoholic" in front of the whole town.

JOAN
(beat, leaning forward)
I operated standing on a crate at Harlem Hospital in 1961 because the men wouldn't give me a stool. (beat) You come from women who do hard things in front of people who are watching. (beat) You'll walk into that basement. (beat) And I'll walk in with you.

Victor turns from the counter. He sees Young Marc in the doorway.

VICTOR
(gently)
Marc-Anthony. (beat) Get your coat. (beat) You and I are going to get pancakes.

YOUNG MARC
(beat)
Is Mama sick?

A long beat. Victor looks at his daughter. Natasha looks at her son.

NATASHA
(beat, barely)
Yes, baby. (beat) Mama's sick. (beat) And today I'm going to start getting better.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 3 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 10:12 AM

Zaria, under anesthesia, her head turned to the right. Graves (52), with Esther, has lifted the depressed fragment of skull and repaired the torn dura beneath it. Marc assists. In the corner, in a scrub cap, a splint over his nose and two purple eyes above the mask, Malcolm stands with his arms folded, waiting his turn.

GRAVES
(calm)
Fragment elevated. (beat) Dura repaired. (beat) No injury to the brain. (beat) She'll keep her memory, her speech and her right hand. (beat) Dr. Smilley, close the scalp over the bone.

ESTHER
(sewing)
Yes, sir.

GRAVES
(stepping back, peeling off his gloves)
Dr. Sloan. (beat) She's yours.

Malcolm steps up to the table across from Esther. Their eyes meet over their masks for one second. Then both of them look down at the little girl's face.

MALCOLM
(beat, completely professional)
Avulsion flap, left temporal and forehead, with a forty percent loss of the frontalis. (beat) Facial nerve: frontal branch intact. (beat) We'll irrigate, debride and replace the flap anatomically. (beat) Layered closure. (beat) Six-oh nylon on the skin. (beat) Dr. Smilley, would you hold this for me? (beat) Exactly here.

Esther takes the forceps and holds the flap exactly where he indicates. They work. Ten minutes pass in silence except for the instruments and the monitor.

MALCOLM
(beat, not looking up)
You used to hold the nails for me. (beat) In the back of the store. (beat) When I was fixing the bikes.

ESTHER
(beat, not looking up)
I was six.

MALCOLM
(beat)
You held them perfectly still. (beat) You never dropped one.

ESTHER
(beat)
Don't, Malcolm.

MALCOLM
(beat, quietly)
Okay.

He keeps sewing. Each stitch on the little girl's forehead is impossibly small and perfectly placed. Marc, across the table, watches Esther watch Malcolm's hands, and sees something in her face that isn't hatred.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 10:47 AM

Dash (34), day 94, propped up, grayer than last week. On the whiteboard: "DAY 94." Glenda knits in the chair. Robert stands at the foot of the bed with the latest labs. Raven beside him.

ROBERT
(beat)
Your creatinine is two-point-four, Mr. Duvall. (beat) Last week it was one-eight. (beat) Your liver numbers are climbing. (beat) Your heart isn't moving enough blood to keep your kidneys and your liver alive. (beat) The milrinone isn't enough anymore.

DASH
(beat, flatly)
The pump.

ROBERT
(beat)
A left ventricular assist device. (beat) A bridge. (beat) It takes over for your left ventricle until a heart comes. (beat) It would let your kidneys and your liver recover. (beat) It would keep you eligible for a transplant.

DASH
(beat)
And it would keep me here.

ROBERT
(beat, honestly)
Most likely. (beat) For a while. (beat) With a battery pack. (beat) And a driveline coming out of your belly.

Dash looks at Raven. Then at his mother.

DASH
(beat)
Mr. Teague. (beat) The drummer. (beat) He went home with one.

ROBERT
(beat)
Mr. Teague's pump was his destination. (beat) Yours would be a bridge.

DASH
(beat, quietly)
I've been standing on this bridge for ninety-four days, Dr. Bullock.

GLENDA
(beat, putting down her knitting)
Darius.

DASH
(beat)
I need a day, Mama. (beat) Dr. Bullock, (beat) give me a day.

ROBERT
(beat)
You can have a day, Mr. Duvall. (beat) Your kidneys may not give you two.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ORTHOPEDICS - CAST ROOM - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 11:08 AM

Snow-day carnage: six wrist fractures in the hallway. Harmony splints a wrist. Camille (29) reads films. A hospital volunteer knocks on the door with a large flat white bakery box tied with purple, green and gold ribbon.

VOLUNTEER
(reading the label)
Delivery for... (beat) "Dr. Harmony Divine." (beat) From Brooklyn.

Harmony looks at Camille. Camille stops reading films. Harmony opens the box. Inside: an enormous braided ring of cinnamon pastry, glazed and covered in purple, green and gold sugar. A King cake. Tucked into the ribbon, a small card in old-fashioned fountain-pen handwriting.

HARMONY
(reading aloud, slowly)
"Dr. Divine. (beat) It is the season of Carnival. (beat) In New Orleans we eat this from Twelfth Night until Mardi Gras. (beat) Whoever finds the baby in her slice must buy the next cake. (beat) I am told you are very good with babies. (beat) A. Toussaint."

Camille stares at the card. She takes it from Harmony's hand and reads it herself, twice.

CAMILLE
(barely)
He drove to the bakery on Fulton Street. (beat) The Louisiana place. (beat) In two feet of snow. (beat) He doesn't drive in snow, Harmony. (beat) He's from New Orleans. (beat) He's afraid of snow.

HARMONY
(beat)
He wrote "Dr. Divine."

CAMILLE
(beat, crying)
He wrote "Dr. Divine."

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 11:31 AM

Marc lies on the bottom bunk with his eyes open. The door opens. Amond comes in, sits on the edge of the bunk and holds out a cup of coffee.

AMOND
(beat)
You flinched at a snowplow this morning.

MARC
(beat)
It was loud.

AMOND
(beat)
You flinched in the ER when the mother said "pit bull." (beat) You flinched when Dr. Okoye dropped a clipboard. (beat) Three times before eleven a.m. (beat) I'm counting.

MARC
(beat)
Don't count.

AMOND
(beat)
I count everything, Marc. (beat) It's what I do instead of feelings. (beat) You know that.

A long silence. Marc sits up. He takes the coffee and doesn't drink it.

MARC
(beat, quietly)
Every time there's a loud noise, everything goes white. (beat) For a second. (beat) Just white. (beat) And then I'm in the scrub room on the floor and my father's face is the first thing I see.

AMOND
(beat)
That's not weakness. (beat) That's your nervous system doing its job a week too late.

MARC
(beat)
I know what it is, Amond. (beat) I've read the chapter.

AMOND
(beat)
Then you know the chapter says "talk to someone." (beat) Dr. Bynum. (beat) Employee assistance. (beat) Somebody who isn't me and isn't your mother. (beat) Before it turns into something that keeps you out of an operating room.

Marc looks at him.

MARC
(beat)
It's not going to keep me out of an operating room.

AMOND
(beat)
I know it isn't. (beat) Because you're going to go talk to somebody. (beat) Today. (beat) I already made the appointment. (beat) Four o'clock.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 11:52 AM

Natasha at her desk. Robert closes the door behind him, crosses the room and sits down in the chair across from her, the way a patient's family sits. Snow falls past the window. A long silence.

NATASHA
(beat)
Say it, Robert.

ROBERT
(beat)
Delphine Ware. (beat) She was a fourth-year surgery resident at Howard in 1981. (beat) I was a third-year medical student. (beat) We were on the same service in September. (beat) Trauma. (beat) Thirty-six-hour calls. (beat) In October there was a surgical meeting in Chicago, her hometown, and the department sent four of us.

Natasha doesn't move.

ROBERT
(beat, his voice very steady, the way it is in an OR)
For two months, Tasha. (beat) October and November of 1981. (beat) It ended before Christmas. (beat) She went back to Chicago in the spring for her chief year. (beat) I never saw her again. (beat) I heard she died in 2003. (beat) In January, her estate's lawyers forwarded me a letter she wrote. (beat) Sealed. (beat) It's in my glove compartment. (beat) I haven't opened it. (beat) That's all of it. (beat) That's everything I know.

A very long silence. The snow falls.

NATASHA
(finally, very quietly)
October 1981.

ROBERT
(beat)
Yes.

NATASHA
(beat)
Grace was six months old. (beat) I was nursing her in Cambridge. (beat) I had a two-year-old and a four-year-old. (beat) I was studying for my second-year pathology exams at the kitchen table at two in the morning with a baby on my breast. (beat) And you were in Chicago.

ROBERT
(beat, barely)
Yes.

Natasha stands. She walks to the window and stands with her back to him, the way he stood that morning. Her hand rises to the glass, the way it did outside OR 1.

NATASHA
(beat, not turning)
I need you to leave my office now, Robert.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EXECUTIVE CORRIDOR - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 11:58 AM

Robert comes out of Natasha's office and closes the door behind him very quietly. He stands in the corridor with one hand still on the doorknob. Marc, coming up the hall with a chart, stops. He sees his father's face.

MARC
(beat)
Dad?

Robert lets go of the doorknob. He looks at his son as if from a very long way away.

MARC
(beat)
Dad. (beat) What happened?

ROBERT
(beat, barely)
Not now, son. (beat) Please.
(beat) Not now.

He walks past Marc down the corridor, his shoulders straight, his steps perfectly even, the way he walks out of an operating room after a death. Marc watches him go. Then he looks at the closed door of the Chief's office.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PEDIATRIC RECOVERY - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 12:21 PM

Zaria, waking up, a neat dressing over her left forehead and temple, a smaller one on her scalp. Trina holds her hand. Malcolm, still in his OR cap, the nose splint under it, and Esther stand at the foot of the bed.

TRINA
(beat)
Is she... (beat) Is her face
going to...

MALCOLM
(gently)
Mrs. Holmes. (beat) Her forehead is going to have a scar. (beat) Here, along the hairline, and here, at the eyebrow. (beat) I put it where I could hide it. (beat) In a year, it'll be a thin line. (beat) In five years, she'll have to point to it to show her friends.

TRINA
(beat, crying)
And her brain?

ESTHER
(beat)
Dr. Graves lifted the broken bone off her brain and fixed the lining underneath. (beat) There was no damage to the brain itself. (beat) She'll be able to read, write, run and make snow angels.

Zaria opens her eyes. She looks at the two doctors at the foot of her bed. She squints at Malcolm's two purple eyes and the splint on his nose.

ZARIA
(hoarse, curious)
Did a dog bite you too?

A beat. Malcolm glances sideways at Esther. Esther doesn't look at him.

MALCOLM
(beat, solemnly)
No, sweetheart. (beat) I walked into a door.

ZARIA
(beat)
That's a dumb door.

ESTHER
(beat, very dry)
It's a very good door, Zaria. (beat) It's been in the family a long time.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGEONS' LOUNGE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 12:44 PM

Lowery sits on the sofa eating a sandwich from the cafeteria. Marc comes in, pours a cup of coffee, and a tray of instruments crashes to the floor in the hallway outside. Marc flinches so hard the coffee sloshes over his hand. Lowery watches him.

LOWERY
(beat)
Sit down, Dr. Bullock.

Marc sits.

LOWERY
(beat, setting down his sandwich)
1967. (beat) I was twenty. (beat) Navy corpsman. (beat) Attached to a Marine battalion outside Da Nang. (beat) A mortar round hit a supply tent forty feet from me. (beat) Two men I'd eaten breakfast with. (beat) For six months after I came home to Bedford-Stuyvesant, every time a car backfired on Fulton Street, I was on the sidewalk.

MARC
(beat)
You never told anybody that.

LOWERY
(beat)
I told the man at the VA in 1968. (beat) Then I told my wife. (beat) Then I went to medical school on the G.I. Bill and never told anybody again. (beat) You know why I'm telling you?

MARC
(beat)
Because I flinched.

LOWERY
(beat)
Because you're going to keep flinching for a while. (beat) And you're going to be ashamed of it. (beat) And I want you to know that the man who taught you to tie a vessel loop spent six months lying on Fulton Street. (beat) And then he stood up. (beat) Go to your four o'clock, Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(beat)
How do you know about my four o'clock?

LOWERY
(beat, picking up his sandwich again)
Dr. Baker made the appointment from my office phone.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ORTHOPEDICS - CAST ROOM - DAY

MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 12:58 PM

Harmony stands by the window with her phone at her ear. The King cake, a third gone, sits on the counter behind her. Camille watches from the light box.

HARMONY
(into the phone, carefully)
Mr. Toussaint? (beat) It's Harmony. (beat) Harmony Divine. (beat) I wanted to thank you for the cake.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(on the phone, formal)
Dr. Divine. (beat) You are welcome. (beat) Did someone find the baby?

HARMONY
(beat)
Not yet. (beat) We've only eaten a third.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(beat)
Then whoever finds it must buy the next one. (beat) That is the rule. (beat) There are no exceptions to the rule, Dr. Divine. (beat) Not for surgeons.

HARMONY
(beat, smiling)
Yes, sir.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(beat, a long pause)
Camille told me. (beat) About the stairwell. (beat) The shoelaces. (beat) My wife once delivered a baby with poultry shears. (beat) In 1979. (beat) I told Camille I never forgave her for the shears.

HARMONY
(beat)
She told me.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(beat, quietly)
I lied. (beat) I forgave her the next morning. (beat) I just never told her so. (beat) It is a bad habit of mine, Dr. Divine. (beat) Forgiving people and not telling them.

Harmony looks across the room at Camille, who has stopped pretending to read films.

24 INT. SAINT PAUL'S CHURCH - BASEMENT - BROOKLINE, MASSACHUSETTS - DAY
FLASHBACK: SUNDAY, MARCH 11, 1990 - 10:04 AM

The basement of a stone church. Folding chairs in a circle. A coffee urn. A banner: "ONE DAY AT A TIME." Twelve people: a mailman, a nun, a man in a Red Sox jacket, a businesswoman. Natasha, thirty-one, sits stiffly in a folding chair in her Sunday coat. Joan sits beside her, upright, her pocketbook on her lap. The CHAIRPERSON (60s) nods at Natasha.

CHAIRPERSON
(gently)
Is there anyone new with us this morning?

A long silence. Natasha stares at the floor. Joan doesn't touch her. Doesn't help. Just sits there.

NATASHA
(finally, barely audible)
My name is Natasha. (beat) I'm... (beat) I'm a doctor. (beat) I'm an obstetrician.

Silence. Nobody reacts. The nun nods slightly.

NATASHA
(beat, her voice breaking)
Last night my eleven-year-old son put out a fire on my stove while I was passed out at the kitchen table. (beat) My name is Natasha. (beat) And I'm an alcoholic.

GROUP
(warmly)
Hi, Natasha.

Natasha covers her face with her hands. Joan, beside her, finally takes her daughter's hand. Then the door at the back of the basement opens. A man comes in: thirty-four, in a Johns Hopkins scrub top under a wet overcoat, unshaven, his eyes red from seven hours of driving through the night. ROBERT BULLOCK. He sits down in the last folding chair by the door. Natasha turns and sees him.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 1:33 PM

Present day. Dash lies with his eyes closed. Glenda sits beside him, her knitting forgotten in her lap.

GLENDA
(beat)
Your daddy was on the loading dock at Philip Morris when it happened. (beat) June ninth, 1990. (beat) He'd had chest pain for three weeks and wouldn't go to the doctor. (beat) He said, "Glenda, if they put a stent in me, I'll be a man with a machine in his heart." (beat) He was proud.

DASH
(eyes still closed)
I know, Mama.

GLENDA
(beat)
You don't know. (beat) You were eighteen and in Raleigh at State. (beat) I was the one who stood in the ER in Concord and watched them pull the sheet up. (beat) Because a man was too proud to have a machine.

Dash opens his eyes.

GLENDA
(beat, fiercely)
You take that pump, Darius. (beat) You take it, and you take the battery pack, and you take the wire coming out of your belly. (beat) And you stand on that bridge as long as it takes. (beat) I'm not watching another sheet go up on another Duvall man because he was too proud to be helped.

DASH
(beat, quietly)
Mama. (beat) Can you get Raven for me?

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - NURSES' STATION - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 1:51 PM

Robert writes orders at the station, perfectly composed, as if nothing has happened. Amond stands beside him, watching him sideways.

ROBERT
(not looking up)
If Mr. Duvall consents, we put in a HeartMate tomorrow at seven. (beat) You'll first-assist.

AMOND
(beat)
Yes, sir.

ROBERT
(beat)
And Dr. Ellison will scrub in as second assist.

Amond looks at him.

AMOND
(beat)
Ellison's in love with him, sir. (beat) You told her yourself in December. (beat) "Be his doctor."

ROBERT
(beat)
I did. (beat) And she has been. (beat) For ninety-four days. (beat) She's hung every drip, checked every pressure and washed his hair on a strike day. (beat) If he asks for her in the room, she'll be in the room. (beat) Holding a retractor. (beat) Not his hand.

Amond studies Robert's face. The perfect calm. The slight tremor at the corner of the mouth.

AMOND
(beat, quietly)
Are you all right, sir?

ROBERT
(beat, still writing)
No, Dr. Baker. (beat) But I can write orders. (beat) That's the thing about this job. (beat) You can always still write orders.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - MICU - BED 4 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 2:16 PM

Gunnery Sergeant Ezekiel Holcomb lies in bed, intubated, warm now, off bypass, his frostbitten fingers wrapped in gauze. His eyes are open. Kennerly sits beside the bed with the VA card. Gloria checks his drips.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Gunny Holcomb. (beat) You're at Queens Grace Hospital. (beat) You were found in a snowbank under the Pulaski Bridge. (beat) Your heart stopped for an hour and ten minutes. (beat) We warmed you up on a bypass machine. (beat) If you can hear me, squeeze my hand.

The old Marine squeezes. Hard.

KENNERLY
(beat, letting out a breath)
Okay. (beat) Okay. (beat) You might lose two fingertips on your left hand, Gunny. (beat) The frostbite. (beat) But you'll keep the hand.

Holcomb looks at Kennerly for a long moment. Then he raises his right hand off the sheet, slowly, and touches two gauze-wrapped fingers to his eyebrow. A salute.

KENNERLY
(beat, quietly)
I'm not a Marine, Gunny.

GLORIA
(beat, not looking up from the drip)
Salute him back, Dr. Kennerly. (beat) He doesn't care what you are. (beat) He cares that you didn't stop pumping.

Kennerly raises his hand and salutes the old man back, badly, but he does it.

28 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 2:39 PM

Two feet of snow. A narrow path shoveled along the sidewalk between the drifts. Natasha, in her camel coat, a scarf over her head, walks quickly away from the hospital. Marc comes out of the revolving door behind her and sees her go. He follows, a block behind, through the snow.

She turns the corner onto Vernon Boulevard. She stops in front of an old brick church, ST. MARY'S, with a side door down a short flight of steps to a basement. A hand-lettered sign is taped to the door: "MONDAY 3 PM. ALL WELCOME." Natasha stands at the top of the steps looking down at the door.

A block behind her, Marc stops in the snow. He knows exactly what that door is. He has known since he was eleven.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

29 INT. ST. MARY'S CHURCH - BASEMENT - VERNON BOULEVARD - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 3:04 PM

The same circle of folding chairs, sixteen years and two hundred miles later. A coffee urn. The same banner: "ONE DAY AT A TIME." Fifteen people: a construction worker in a Carhartt jacket, two nurses in scrubs from QGH, a young man with a backpack. And, in the third chair from the end, in her church coat with her pocketbook on her lap: Bernadette "Bernie" Watkins (55). Natasha comes down the steps and stops in the doorway when she sees her.

BERNIE
(beat, quietly, without surprise)
There's a seat by me, Dr. Donohue.

Natasha sits beside her. The CHAIRPERSON nods around the circle.

CHAIRPERSON
(gently)
Would anyone like to share?

A long silence. Natasha looks at her hands.

NATASHA
(beat, quietly)
My name is Natasha. (beat) I'm an alcoholic. (beat) I've been sober since March eleventh, 1990. (beat) Fifteen years and eleven months.

GROUP
(warmly)
Hi, Natasha.

NATASHA
(beat)
Today my husband told me something he's been carrying for twenty-four years. (beat) Something that happened when I had three babies under five and was trying to finish medical school. (beat) I sat in my office for three hours after he left. (beat) And for the first time in a long time, I wanted a drink so badly I could taste it.

Bernie, beside her, doesn't move. She just sits there, steady, the way Joan once did.

NATASHA
(beat)
I didn't drink. (beat) I walked out in the snow and came here. (beat) And I'm sitting here thinking that eight years after he did what he did, I was the one passed out at a kitchen table. (beat) And my son was the one who put out the fire. (beat) And my husband drove seven hours through the night from Baltimore to sit in the back of a church basement in Brookline. (beat) He never asked me for anything. (beat) Not once. (beat) Not an apology. (beat) He just came.

She wipes her eyes.

NATASHA
(beat)
I don't know what I'm going to do. (beat) I just know I'm not going to decide it with a drink in my hand. (beat) That's all. (beat) Thank you for letting me share.

GROUP
Thanks, Natasha.

Bernie, without looking at her, puts her hand over Natasha's on the folding chair.

BERNIE
(very quietly)
Twenty-two years, Dr. Donohue. (beat) Tuesdays and Mondays. (beat) I never told you. (beat) It's not the kind of thing you put on a résumé.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - DR. BYNUM'S OFFICE - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 4:02 PM

A small office with soft lamps, a box of tissues, a window full of snow. DR. HAROLD BYNUM (63), the consult-liaison psychiatrist in a bow tie, sits in an armchair. Marc sits on the sofa across from him, elbows on his knees.

DR. BYNUM
(gently)
Dr. Baker says you've been flinching at loud noises.

MARC
(beat)
Dr. Baker counts things.

DR. BYNUM
(beat, a small smile)
He does. (beat) He also said he had to drag you here. (beat) What happens when you hear a loud noise, Dr. Bullock?

MARC
(beat)
Everything goes white. (beat) For a second. (beat) Then I'm on the floor in the scrub room. (beat) My father's face. (beat) I can't hear. (beat) Then I'm back.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
And how did you feel during the four hours? (beat) With your hand on the shell?

Marc is quiet for a long time.

MARC
(beat, finally)
Calm.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
Calm.

MARC
(beat)
Completely calm. (beat) Like I'd been waiting for it my whole life. (beat) The sergeant said it worried him. (beat) He said the ones whose hands don't shake have already decided something.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
What had you decided?

Marc looks out the window at the snow. A plow scrapes past on Jackson Avenue. He flinches, and doesn't hide it this time.

MARC
(beat, barely)
When I was eleven, I came downstairs at midnight, and there was a fire on the stove. (beat) My mother was asleep at the kitchen table. (beat) She'd been drinking. (beat) I got the fire extinguisher from under the sink and put it out. (beat) I didn't scream. (beat) I didn't wake my sisters. (beat) I just held still and did what needed to be done. (beat) And then I woke her up and put her to bed.

DR. BYNUM
(beat, very gently)
And afterward?

MARC
(beat)
Afterward, she got sober. (beat) The next morning. (beat) She's been sober ever since. (beat) She's the bravest person I know. (beat) We never talked about it. (beat) Not once. (beat) Not in sixteen years.

DR. BYNUM
(beat)
So the calm in that operating room...

MARC
(beat)
I've been holding things still since I was eleven years old, Dr. Bynum. (beat) A bomb is just one more thing on the stove.

Dr. Bynum hands him the box of tissues. Marc looks at it for a long beat. Then he takes one.

DR. BYNUM
(beat, quietly)
Same time next Monday, Dr. Bullock?

MARC
(beat)
Same time next Monday.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 4:46 PM

Dash sits up. Raven stands at the bedside. Glenda has stepped out to give them privacy.

DASH
(beat)
I'll take the pump. (beat) Tomorrow. (beat) Seven a.m.

RAVEN
(beat, letting out a breath she's been holding all day)
Okay. (beat) Okay. (beat) Good.

DASH
(beat)
On one condition.

RAVEN
(beat)
What?

DASH
(beat)
You're in the room. (beat) Not in the gallery. (beat) Not in the hallway. (beat) In the room. (beat) Dr. Bullock said you could scrub in.

RAVEN
(beat)
He said that?

DASH
(beat)
Twenty minutes ago. (beat) He said, "She'll hold a retractor, Mr. Duvall. (beat) Not your hand." (beat) I said, "That's fine, Doc. (beat) She can hold my hand after."

Raven laughs and cries at the same time.

DASH
(beat, quietly)
And Raven. (beat) Tomorrow's Valentine's Day. (beat) I've never had a Valentine I liked. (beat) If I wake up with a machine in my belly, (beat) you're my Valentine. (beat) Don't argue.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
I'm not arguing.

32 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ELEVATOR - DAY
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 5:31 PM

Esther waits at the elevator bank on seven with her coat on. The doors open. Malcolm is inside, alone, in his overcoat, the splint on his nose. He sees her. He starts to step out.

ESTHER
(beat)
Stay in the elevator, Malcolm.

He stops. She steps in beside him. The doors close. A long silence as the numbers count down. Six. Five.

MALCOLM
(beat, quietly)
Thank you. (beat) For the elevator.

ESTHER
(beat, eyes on the numbers)
Don't.

MALCOLM
(beat)
Okay.

Four. Three.

ESTHER
(beat, still not looking at him)
Her stitches were perfect. (beat) Zaria's. (beat) I counted. (beat) Seventy-two. (beat) Every one exactly the same.

MALCOLM
(beat)
You held the flap perfectly still. (beat) You always did.

Two. One. The doors open on the lobby. Esther steps out first.

ESTHER
(beat, not turning around)
Happy birthday, Malcolm. (beat) It's not a gift. (beat) It's just the elevator.

33 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 6:14 PM

The bar, busy with snowbound regulars. Monty (43) behind the bar. Malcolm sits on a stool with a bourbon, his black eyes deepening. Marc comes in, shaking snow off his coat, and stops when he sees him. Monty glances between them.

MALCOLM
(beat)
You're Marc.

MARC
(beat)
You're Malcolm.

MALCOLM
(beat, raising his glass)
Clayton told me. (beat) Esther told me nothing. (beat) She told me nothing about you so loudly that I knew everything.

Marc sits down two stools away. Monty slides him a beer.

MARC
(beat)
You broke them. (beat) Her and Clayton. (beat) A year ago. (beat) In Boston.

MALCOLM
(beat, honestly)
I did. (beat) I've never done a worse thing to anyone in my life. (beat) I'd undo it if I could. (beat) I can't. (beat) So I came to Queens to be the kind of man who stays in the elevator.

MARC
(beat)
Why are you telling me this?

MALCOLM
(beat)
Because you held a bomb for four hours last Sunday. (beat) Everybody in this building is talking about you. (beat) And because when Esther walked out of the Plastics corridor this morning with her hand shaking, she looked down the hall toward the elevators the way she used to look for me in the back of her father's store. (beat) And I'm not the one she was looking for anymore.

A long beat. Marc drinks his beer.

MARC
(beat)
Happy birthday, Dr. Sloan.

MALCOLM
(beat, raising his glass again)
It's tomorrow.

MONTY
(wiping the bar)
It's tomorrow in nine minutes in Boston. (beat) That's close enough.

MALCOLM
(beat)
It's tomorrow in six hours, Monty. (beat) Same time zone.

MONTY
(beat, pouring him another)
Not in my bar.

34 INT. NATASHA AND ROBERT'S BROWNSTONE - RIVERSIDE DRIVE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 7:36 PM

Robert sits alone at the kitchen island in his coat. He hasn't turned on the lights. The front door opens. Natasha comes in, snow on her scarf, and switches on the lamp. They look at each other.

ROBERT
(beat, barely)
I didn't know if you'd come home.

NATASHA
(beat, taking off her scarf)
I went to a meeting. (beat) On Vernon Boulevard. (beat) Bernie was there. (beat) Twenty-two years.

ROBERT
(beat)
Bernie.

NATASHA
(beat)
I didn't know either. (beat) Everybody's carrying something, Robert. (beat) Even Bernie.

She sits down across the island from him. Not close. Not far.

NATASHA
(beat)
I'm not leaving. (beat) And I'm not forgiving you. (beat) Not tonight. (beat) Maybe not for a long time. (beat) I'm going to be angry, and I'm going to let myself be angry, and I'm not going to drink about it.

ROBERT
(beat)
That's fair.

NATASHA
(beat)
But I sat in that basement today and remembered something. (beat) March 1990. (beat) You drove seven hours from Baltimore in the middle of the night. (beat) You sat in the last chair by the door. (beat) You never said a word. (beat) You never asked me for anything. (beat) I'm going to remember that too, Robert. (beat) Both things. (beat) At the same time.

Robert puts his face in his hands.

ROBERT
(beat, muffled)
The letter.

NATASHA
(beat, very calmly)
Don't open it. (beat) Not yet. (beat) Not until we're both ready to know what's in it. (beat) Whatever a dead woman wanted you to know after twenty-four years can wait until I can stand in the same room with it.

ROBERT
(beat)
Yes.

NATASHA
(beat, standing)
I'm sleeping in Grace's room. (beat) Good night, Robert.

35 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 8:31 PM

The kitchen is warm and full. Harmony and Camille sit at the table with the rest of the King cake. Amond eats a slice. Raven makes tea. And at the end of the table, for

the first time since January twentieth, sits Arianna, her coat still on, her kidney keychain on the table beside her plate. Marc comes in from the snow. Mercy greets him at the door like he's been gone a year.

CAMILLE
(holding up something tiny between two fingers)
Found it.

A tiny plastic baby, pink, from her slice of King cake.

HARMONY
(laughing)
You have to buy the next cake. (beat) Your father's rule.

CAMILLE
(beat, smiling)
I know. (beat) I'm going to buy it from the place on Fulton Street. (beat) And I'm going to take it to Halsey Street. (beat) And you're coming with me.

Harmony stops laughing. She looks at Camille.

HARMONY
(beat)
To your father's?

CAMILLE
(beat)
He said "Dr. Divine" on the card, Choir. (beat) And "Is she safe?" on the phone. (beat) He's forgiven us and not told us. (beat) We're going to go make him say it.

At the end of the table, Arianna looks at Raven over her tea.

ARIANNA
(beat, quietly)
Tomorrow's the pump.

RAVEN
(beat)
Seven a.m.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I'll be in the gallery. (beat)
Not for him. (beat) For you.

Raven sets down the teapot. She looks at Arianna for a long moment.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
Thank you.

36 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 9:28 PM

Clayton reads on the sofa. Esther comes in and sits down beside him, still in her coat. Her right knuckles are bruised.

CLAYTON
(beat, looking at her hand)
I heard.

ESTHER
(beat)
The whole hospital heard.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Natasha's not filing anything.

ESTHER
(beat)
I know. (beat) I sewed with him today. (beat) Five hours. (beat)
A seven-year-old's face.

CLAYTON
(beat, carefully)
And?

Esther stares at her bruised knuckles.

ESTHER
(beat, honestly)
His hands are still the best hands I've ever seen. (beat) That's the truth. (beat) No more Octobers.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
They always were.

ESTHER
(beat)
And I rode the elevator with him. (beat) Seven floors. (beat) I told him happy birthday.

Clayton closes his book. He reaches over and takes her bruised hand in both of his, gently, the way a surgeon examines an injury.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Then tomorrow you're going to put ice on this. (beat) And on Thursday, we're going to Montague Street. (beat) And Dr. Greenidge is going to have the best session of her career.

37 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - MICU - BED 4 - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 10:14 PM

Gunny Holcomb, extubated now, hoarse, propped up, his bandaged left hand on a pillow. Kennerly, long past the end of his shift, sits in the chair with a printed sheet of paper. Celia Montague's handwriting is scrawled across the top.

KENNERLY
(beat)
Ms. Montague from social work made some calls. (beat) There's a bed for you at the James J. Peters VA in the Bronx when you're ready to leave here. (beat) Then a room in a veterans' residence on Kingsbridge Road. (beat) With heat.

Gunny Holcomb looks at him for a long time.

GUNNY HOLCOMB
(hoarse, barely)
Why'd you keep pumping, Doc? (beat) An hour and ten minutes. (beat) I was dead.

KENNERLY
(beat)
You weren't warm yet, Gunny. (beat) You're not dead until you're warm and dead. (beat) And because a Marine walked a bomb out of this hospital last week so a bunch of us could go home. (beat) I figured I owed the Corps one.

The old man reaches over with his good right hand and grips Kennerly's wrist.

GUNNY HOLCOMB
(beat, rough)
Semper fi, Doc.

KENNERLY
(beat, not trusting his voice)
Semper fi, Gunny.

38 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PEDIATRIC RECOVERY - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 11:02 PM

Zaria sleeps. Trina dozes in the chair. The door opens quietly. Malcolm, in his overcoat, back from Monty's, comes in. He crouches beside the bed with a penlight and lifts the edge of the dressing, checking the stitches one by one. He makes a small note in the chart. He replaces the dressing perfectly. He stands to leave and sees that Trina's eyes are open.

TRINA
(whispering)
It's eleven o'clock at night, Doctor.

MALCOLM
(whispering)
I always check my first night's work, Mrs. Holmes. (beat) Old habit. (beat) A woman in Mattapan taught me that you finish what you start.

TRINA
(beat)
Your eyes look terrible.

MALCOLM
(beat, smiling)
I know. (beat) I deserved every bit of it.

TAG

39 INT. THE DONOHUE-BULLOCK APARTMENT - BROOKLINE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FLASHBACK: SATURDAY, MARCH 10, 1990 - 11:58 PM

The smoky kitchen. Natasha has gone to bed. Young Marc, eleven, in his Batman pajamas, carefully puts the fire extinguisher back under the sink. He closes the cabinet. He goes to the stove and checks every knob, one at a time. Off. Off. Off. Off. Then he checks them all again.

MARC (V.O.)
Everybody has a day they don't talk about.

40 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
MONDAY, FEBRUARY 13, 2006 - 11:58 PM

The present. The house is dark. Marc, twenty-seven, stands alone in the kitchen in his robe. Mercy watches from her bed by the radiator. He goes to the stove and checks every knob, one at a time. Off. Off. Off. Off. Then he stops himself before he checks them again. He stands there with his hand hovering over the stove.

MARC (V.O.)
A day so big that every day after it is shaped around the hole it left.

He takes his hand away. He doesn't check them a second time.

MARC (V.O.)
The only way to fill a hole like that is to finally say out loud what fell into it. (beat) To a stranger in a bow tie. (beat) To a circle of folding chairs. (beat) To the person across the kitchen island.

He turns off the light. Mercy's tail thumps once in the dark.

MARC (V.O.)
And then you check the stove once. (beat) Just once. (beat) And you go to bed.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x18

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

THE NEW YORK TIMES: "RECORD SNOW BURIES CITY"

Monday, February 13, 2006

"A blizzard dropped 26.9 inches of snow on Central Park on Saturday and Sunday, the most since record-keeping began in 1869, shutting the airports and stranding travelers... Sanitation crews worked through the night..."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "CHENEY ACCIDENTALLY SHOOTS FELLOW HUNTER"

Monday, February 13, 2006

"WASHINGTON (AP) -- Vice President Dick Cheney accidentally shot and wounded a companion, Harry Whittington, during a quail hunt on a Texas ranch on Saturday. The incident was not disclosed until Sunday..."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Monday, February 13, 2006, 8:22 AM

"DAY ONE, ROUND ONE. The new Chief of Plastics arrived at 7:02 AM looking like a cologne ad, asked for the EAST STAIRS (?!), and by 7:41 had a broken nose courtesy of a certain intern from Boston with a right cross we can only call 'Mattapan.' He says he walked into a door. We have three witnesses who say the door was 5'6" and wearing scrubs. Also: a frozen Marine came back to life on bypass in Trauma 2 after 70 minutes. Not dead until warm and dead, people." Comments (5,118).

Card tucked into a King cake (Augustin Toussaint to Harmony Divine)

Delivered Monday, February 13, 2006

"Dr. Divine. It is the season of Carnival. In New Orleans we eat this from Twelfth Night until Mardi Gras. Whoever finds the baby in her slice must buy the next cake. I am told you are very good with babies. A. Toussaint."

Card inside a pink T-Mobile Sidekick (Marc Bullock to Imani Burrell)

Given at the repast, Friday, February 10, 2006

"From your daddy. He said yes."

Sign beneath a newspaper photo, Surgical Floor nurses' station

Posted February 2006

"SGT. ISAAC BURRELL. 1961-2006. HE WALKED IT OUT."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x18

New Canon Established

- **MALCOLM SLOAN'S ON-SCREEN DEBUT** (37; 38 on February 14): Chief of Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery, first day February 13, 2006. He arrived at 7:02 AM and took the east stairs. **Esther punched him** (a right cross; Clarence Smilley taught all five daughters boxing in the back of Smilley's Hardware) in the Plastics corridor at 7:38 AM: 'That's for the stairs... I don't want you hiding from me.' This is the counterpart of Derek punching Mark. He set his own nose, has two black eyes, and told everyone he 'walked into a door.' Natasha did not read the three witness statements. **He used the elevator; Esther rode seven floors with him** ('It's just the elevator'). Esther told Clayton: 'His hands are still the best hands I've ever seen.'
- **Clayton and Malcolm** met for the first time since Back Bay in February 2005. Clayton: 'I'm her husband. I'm staying her husband.' Malcolm: 'I came for her... For Ma Corinne's table.' **Malcolm and Marc** met at Monty's: 'She looked down the hall toward the elevators... I'm not the one she was looking for anymore.' Malcolm and Esther operated together on Zaria Holmes (72 stitches). Esther held the nails for Malcolm when she was six, while he fixed bikes in the store.
- **ROBERT'S CONFESSION** (11:52 AM, Chief's office): a two-month affair with **Dr. Delphine Ware** (then a 4th-year Howard surgery resident) in **October and November 1981**, beginning at a surgical meeting in Chicago, her hometown. Robert was a third-year medical student. It ended before Christmas, and she returned to Chicago in spring 1982. **Grace was six months old**, and Natasha was a second-year HMS student in Cambridge. Robert revealed the sealed letter in the glove compartment, unopened. **Natasha: '<u>Don't open it. Not until we're both ready to know.</u>'** She is not leaving and not forgiving, and is 'sleeping in Grace's room.' **Mariah's existence is still unknown to everyone** (S11 payoff).
- **THE 1990 FLASHBACKS** (counterpart of the Ellis flashbacks): Saturday, March 10, 1990, 11:41 PM, at the Brookline apartment, **Marc (11) put out a stove fire with an extinguisher** while Natasha (31) was passed out drunk at the kitchen table. Robert was in Baltimore (Hopkins). On March 11, **Joan Mercer** took Natasha to her first AA meeting at Saint Paul's in Brookline ('You come from women who do hard things in front of people who are watching'), and Victor took Marc for pancakes. **Robert drove seven hours overnight from Baltimore** and sat in the last chair. **Natasha's sobriety date is March 11, 1990** (15 years, 11 months). Marc checks the stove knobs twice, a habit since 1990; tonight he checked once.
- **Natasha shared at an AA meeting** in St. Mary's basement on Vernon Boulevard (Mondays, 3 PM). **Bernie Watkins has 22 years of sobriety** (Mondays and Tuesdays) and never told Natasha. **Marc started therapy with Dr. Harold Bynum** (Amond made the appointment from Lowery's phone), Mondays at 4 PM, for post-blast startle and dissociation. He told Bynum about the fire for the first time in 16 years: 'A bomb is just one more thing on the stove.' **Lowery's backstory:** Navy corpsman with Marines near Da Nang in 1967, then postwar startle on Fulton Street in Bed-Stuy, then the VA in 1968, then medical school on the G.I. Bill.
- **Dash consented to a HeartMate bridge LVAD** for February 14 at 7 AM (creatinine 2.4, rising LFTs; day 94). Glenda told him his father died June 9, 1990, refusing 'a machine.' Robert: Amond first-assists and **Raven second-assists** ('She'll hold a retractor. Not his hand'). Dash: 'You're my Valentine. Don't argue.' Arianna will watch from the gallery 'for you.' **Arianna came**

back to 49th Avenue for dinner, the first time since January 20.

- **Augustin sent Harmony a King cake** addressed to 'Dr. Divine' (he drove to the Louisiana bakery on Fulton Street in the snow, and he fears snow). By phone: 'Forgiving people and not telling them... a bad habit of mine.' **Camille found the baby**, so she buys the next cake and will take Harmony to Halsey Street. **Gunny Ezekiel Holcomb** (54, Beirut 1983), found in a snowbank under the Pulaski Bridge with a core temperature of 24.1 C, survived 70 minutes of arrest via bypass rewarming (Kennerly, Arianna, R. Bullock, Baker). Celia got him a bed at the Bronx VA. 'Semper fi, Doc.' **Burrell's funeral** was Friday, February 10, at Greater Allen Cathedral. Marc gave Imani a pink Sidekick: 'From your daddy. He said yes.' **Dr. Nnamdi Okoye** (PGY-4) runs the board during Elxa's leave (to April); Elxa left eleven pages, ending with 'Watch Bullock.' Russell is extubated and wears a helmet until the bone flap goes back in about six weeks.

Knowledge Tracker (as of February 13, 2006)

Item	Who knows
Robert's 1981 affair with Delphine Ware	Robert, Natasha; Amond (inferred from Langley); Bernie (from the share, without names)
The 1990 fire and Natasha's drinking	Natasha, Robert, Victor, Joan, Elxa, Grace (as children); now Dr. Bynum and the St. Mary's group
Bernie is in recovery	Natasha
Mariah Pettaway	No one. Locked until Season 11
Heir designation	Still secret (Victor wants to move it up)

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Gunny Ezekiel Holcomb	7/4/1951 (54)	Severe hypothermia (24.1 C), VF arrest for 70 minutes	CPR; warm irrigation; femoral bypass rewarming; defibrillation at 30 C (Kennerly; Cummings; R. Bullock; Baker)	ROSC; extubated; frostbite to two fingertips
Zaria Holmes	9/3/1998 (7)	Dog bite: left forehead and temporal avulsion, depressed skull fracture	Elevation and dural repair (Graves; Smilley); flap replacement, 72 sutures (Sloan; Smilley; Bullock)	Neurologically intact
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	8/8/1971 (34)	DCM, worsening renal and hepatic function, day 94	LVAD consented for February 14 (R. Bullock; Baker; Ellison)	Pending
Russell Jeffries	4/3/1975 (30)	Post-craniectomy	Extubated; helmet	Recovering

New Characters

- **Dr. Malcolm Sloan**, on-screen debut (in MA-005). **Dr. Nnamdi Okoye** (b. October 1, 1974), PGY-4. **Gunnery Sgt. Ezekiel Holcomb** (b. July 4, 1951). **Zaria Holmes** (b. September 3, 1998) and **Trina Holmes** (b. December 15, 1976).

- **Dr. Joan Mercer** and **Victor Donohue** appear in flashback, with **Young Marc** (11) and **Natasha** (31).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- The Blizzard of February 11-12, 2006 dropped 26.9 inches on Central Park, then the city's largest snowfall since record-keeping began in 1869. Vice President Cheney accidentally shot Harry Whittington on February 11, 2006, and it was disclosed the next day. Greater Allen A.M.E. Cathedral in Jamaica hosts large funerals. The James J. Peters VA Medical Center is in the Bronx.
- Medicine: in severe accidental hypothermia, 'nobody is dead until warm and dead.' Extracorporeal rewarming (cardiopulmonary bypass or ECMO) can produce good neurologic survival after prolonged CPR, and defibrillation is often deferred until core temperature reaches about 30 C. Dog-bite facial avulsions are irrigated, debrided and replaced anatomically, often with excellent cosmetic results in children, and a depressed skull fracture with dural tear needs elevation and repair. Rabies observation of the biting dog is standard. A bridge LVAD is indicated when inotrope-dependent heart failure causes worsening end-organ (renal, hepatic) function. Startle, dissociation and hypervigilance after a blast are common acute stress responses, and early counseling helps.